Cycle	Unique ID	Submission	Question / Clarification	Supporting Documentation	CAR Response	CAR Notes	CAR Approval	Approval Date (MM.DD.YYYY)
RP1	2021.A.1	August 5th, 2021	~~is our below proposal for sampling in frozen soil~~ acceptable? Our current protocol is: If < 1" of the soil profile is frozen : sample and make no indication in Indigo Fields (IF); If 1" ≤ soil profile is frozen ≤ 3" : sample and indicate "yes" in IF for the question "Is any portion of the soil profile frozen"; If > 3" of the soil profile is frozen : Do Not Sample; If any point in the field results in "Do Not Sample" : abandon sampling and discard previously collected soil samples for the field (we will try to avoid taking many samples before coming to this conclusion).	n/a	Yes this is acceptable for now since the implementation of (1) and (2) would apply to both the baseline and project and this will not risk additional crediting. Indigo is approved to implement this process.		*Approved*	8.23.2021
RP1	2021.A.2	August 5th, 2021	If a grower changes a practice in Y1, does not continue the practice in Y2, but picks it back up in Y3, is that grower eligible for payments for their Y1 practice even though they missed Y2?	n/a	Yes. Once a grower is eligible, the fields remain in the project and able to generate credits for the duration of the project's crediting period.		*Approved*	8.23.2021
RP1	2021.A.3	August 5th, 2021	Can tile drainage be installed during the baseline period?	n/a	Yes. The Reserve will allow fields with tile drainage in the baseline, and allow the expansion of tile drainage within a given field. Existing cropping and the presenece of tile drainage will ensure no expansion into systems without such elements already present, so there will be no significant change into sensitive areas.	SO: Reserve approves projects on any field that contained tile drainage at any point prior to start date. Conducting maintenance work on such tile drainage at any point, including during the crediting period, will also be fine.	*Approved*	8.23.2021
RP1	2021.A.4	August 5th, 2021	It's particularly challenging to complete a random sample in cropland (due to tall crops, flooding, frozen soil, etc.), yet paying growers soon after enrollment is key to the success of cropland carbon credits. How can project developers submit a monitoring report with a partial sample?	Addressing_incomplete_field_data_v4.4	The Reserve gives approval to Indigo to use the techniques for addressing missing data using post-stratification following the guidance and requirements written in the attachment (Addressing_incomplete_field_data_v4.4). Note that version 4 of that document was approved by an external reviewer, John Kershaw; minor updates made since that version are described in Row 34.		*Approved*	8.23.2021
RP1	2021.A.5	August 5th, 2021	Can fields enrolled in Nori transfer into the Indigo project under the SEP?	n/a	Yes. These fields will be allowed to transfer into a SEP project so long as they can meet the standard requirements for transfer projects under the CAR Program.	~~SO: Yes, we will allow such transfers.~~ We may need to think further about any credits that were issued under the Nori program, and attempt to confirm there is no overlap between crediting under the two programs. Perhaps we put the burden of this on PD, and require PD submit some assessment of double counting. If no sequestration credits issued under previous registry out of which project is being transferred, then no such concern raised.	*Approved*	8.23.2021
RP1	2021.A.6	August 5th, 2021	Will credits issued under another program prior to transferring into the Reserve be subject to any permanence obligations under the SEP?	n/a	No. The only obligation with respect to credits issued prior to transferring a project (or part thereof, ie a field) is to ensure double counting does not occur.	SO: No, but see answer above, we will likely explore double counting risks.	*Approved*	8.23.2021
RP1	2021.A.7	August 5th, 2021	Section 7.1 states that all documentation, including the Monitoring Plan will be made public. Is it possible to redact information and/or supporting documentation from the public submission as needed?	n/a	Yes. The project developer is allowed to redact information in the Monitoring Plan/Report and ask to exclude certain supporting documentation from publishing so long as there remains a strong level of detail in the Monitoring Plan/Report for the public to understand the project scope.		*Approved*	8.23.2021
RP1	2021.A.8	August 5th, 2021	There seems to be an error in Section 8.4.1. The verification intensity requirements from 8.4 are different from 8.4.1. Can you please specify which section we should defer to?	n/a	Yes. Please follow the guidance in Section 8.4.		*Approved*	8.23.2021
RP1	2021.A.9	August 5th, 2021	Would you agree with the approach included in the attached document for handling cases where unvalidated practices occur concurrently with validated practices? Note that Indigo will delineate clearly what CFGs and PCs are validated in the main text of the Validation Report, which will be provided to the Reserve and made public during verification. Any handling of unvalidated practices following this proposal will also be clearly delineated, provided to the Reserve, and made public during verification.	Proposal for handling unvalidated practices in modeling	Yes. Due to the previous approval from Bill Salas and Brian McConkey, the Reserve supports the proposal submitted by Indigo.		*Approved*	8.23.2021
RP1	2021.A.10	August 5th, 2021	The SEP v1.0 and the accompanying modeling guidance document specify that "stacked" practice studies may only be used once per Validation Report, and only then if the validation dataset for the given PC x CFG combo contains at least one "isolated" study. This set of restrictions contradicts the notion that stacked practice studies are well-suited for model validation, given the additional complexity required to properly simulate stacked practices. Can we get an exception to the requirement that studies for stacked practices may only be used once per validation report?	n/a	Yes. The Reserve will allow stacked practice studies to not be limited for a single use per validation report, but instead be allowed to be used for all PCs included in the stack. The remaining restriction that the validation dataset for a given combo must contain at least one isolated treatment comparison is still required.		*Approved*	8.23.2021

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RP1	2021.A.11	August 5th, 2021	Is our below proposal for handling validation data sets where the soil was not measured to a depth of 30 cm acceptable? For studies used in model validation having SOC stock measurements made at depths other than 30 cm, we propose that a general approach be allowed where either the model or the measurements are extrapolated using empirical functions derived from a trusted data source based on the relevant soil series, such as the Pedon database. This adjustment must take into account added uncertainty by doing this extrapolation, and then be used in evaluating model bias and uncertainty, per the modeling guidance requirements. The process employed to do this will be fully documented in the Model Validation Report, and evaluated by the third-party reviewer during the validation approval process.	n/a	Yes. This is reasonable and Indigo is approved to move forward with this logic.		*Approved*	8.23.2021
RP1	2021.A.12	August 5th, 2021	Can the content of a Type 3 Model Validation Report (that references an independently reviewed Type 2 Report) be included directly in the MP rather that in a separate report requiring a (redundant) independent review?	n/a	Yes. The Reserve will allow this so long as the Type 2 Report is fairly straightforward.		*Approved*	8.23.2021
RP1	2021.A.13	August 5th, 2021	Would you agree with the attached proposal to allow Soy x Inorg N to be considered validated if both the Corn x Inorg N and Soy x Cropping combos are validated? Note: This approach was verbally approved by Brian McConkey on 12/4/20.	Proposal for validating N fertilizer on the soy Crop Functional Group	Yes. The Reserve will allow this with the understanding that this will be included in the Model Validation Report for an expert to review and approve.		*Approved*	8.23.2021
RP1	2021.A.14	August 5th, 2021	We have conducted research into the CH4 emissions from upland soils and are looking to seek approval for a de minimis demonstration attached. It includes: 1. We will account for all project CH4 emissions from livestock and biomass burning (using the protocol default equations, not models). 2. The biogeochemical models are not yet able to be validated for soil CH4 dynamics on cropland. However, we believe the emissions from soil CH4 to be de minimis, because: - Non-wetland soils are generally a net CH4 sink; and, - Regenerative agricultural practices tend to strengthen, rather than weaken this sink. 3. Thus, we should be allowed to use biogeochemical models that are not validated for soil CH4. Note; Indigo will be seeking SOC credits on such lands.	CH4 emissions de min_v1	The Reserve will allow this with the understanding that this will be included in the Model Validation Report for an expert to review and approve.		*Approved*	8.23.2021
RP1	2021.A.15	August 5th, 2021	Can fields using irrigation as a background practice, i.e. not being changed to earn credits, be exempt from model validation requirements for the Irrigation PC? The model guidance is not clear on this, and the effects of irrigation on soil moisture are already captured via the effects of precipitation. Note that Indigo is assuming irrigation to be precipitation for all intensive purposes.	Proposal for accepting background irrigation	Yes. The Reserve will allow this with the understanding that this will be included in the Model Validation Report for an expert to review and approve.		*Approved*	8.23.2021
RP1	2021.A.16	August 5th, 2021	We propose that "removal of fence rows" to not be considered a violation of the project definition.	n/a	The Reserve will approve this, however it noted that if there is any evidence that the given area cleared has some environmental significance (ie. Wildlife corridor) then it may trigger further review from the verification body and/or the Reserve.		*Approved*	8.23.2021
RP1	2021.A.17	August 5th, 2021	Indigo requests to disregard the last sentence of Section 7.2 which states: "For projects with multiple eligible crop fields and an initial reporting period encompassing two cultivation cycles, the initial reporting period must include two complete cultivation cycles for each eligible crop field (Figure 7.4)."	n/a	The Reserve will approve this given that this sentence is expected to be removed in the upcoming protocol revision.		*Approved*	8.23.2021

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RP1	2021.A.18	August 5th, 2021	Request clarification on credit generation timeline with the proposed solution: Can fields that have historically employed deep till and have subsequently adopted a new tillage practice other than no till, be issued credits earned as of their start date? In other words, fields that fall into this category will have to wait until they adopt a new tillage practice other than no till before they can get credited, but they will be issued credits earned as of their start date. (Similar to the stacking logic 1.b(i) in Section 3 of the SEP)	n/a	No. Fields that have historically employed deep till and have subsequently adopted a new tillage practice other than no till, be issued credits earned as of the reporting period for which they demonstrated tillage was employed. Fields that have employed deep tillage more than once on a given field during the historical baseline period will be subject to this restriction. Indigo must demonstrate that that the given field employed tillage in the first 5 reporting periods following the field start date to remove such fields from this restriction.		*Approved*	8.23.2021
RP1	2021.A.19	August 5th, 2021	Can we proceed under the interpretation that the model needs to be validated only for SOC stock changes, and not for SOC stocks as well?	n/a	Yes.		*Approved*	8.23.2021
RP1	2021.A.20	August 5th, 2021	Can Indigo identify the appropriate county for a field by using the field centroid (calculated by the GIS system)? Therefore if you have fields which cross county boundaries, then the county covering the centroid of that field will be used to determine eligiblity under the PST.	n/a	Yes. The Reserve will allow counties to be identified using the field centroid.		*Approved*	8.23.2021
RP1	2021.A.21	August 5th, 2021	The SEP v1.0 and the accompanying modeling guidance document require that validation be performed on all combinations of Crop Functional Group (CFG) and Practice Category (PC) undergoing a practice change for credits. However, it does not indicate whether validation is necessary for CFGs and PCs remaining unchanged, i.e. employing the same practice through time. Requiring these unchanging or "background" combinations to be validated using the same or similar requirements currently described in the Model Guidance document presents a significant validation burden that may not be feasible due to lack of experimental datasets, with the resulting impact of greatly reducing what management practice changes can be eligible for crediting. Further, such a requirement may not be justified given the intention of validating practice changes described in the modeling guidance document. Therefore, we have developed an approach for how Indigo will handle background practices, and are looking to seek approval for the attached proposal.	Proposal for handling background practices	The Reserve will allow this with the understanding that this will be included in the Model Validation Report for an expert to review and approve.	SO: Explore how this information will be made available to verifiers and registry staff, to facilitate verification that only validated PC/CFGs have been credited.	*Approved*	8.23.2021
RP1	2021.A.22	August 5th, 2021	Would participation in this U.S. Cotton Trust Protocol cause a field to be considered ineligible due to credit stacking, or is this program ok? https://trustuscotton.org/	n/a	After further investigation it was deemed by both parties (CAR and Indigo) that fields enlisted in the Cotton Trust Protocol would not be eligible due to the similarities between GHGs & co-benefit reporting.		*Approved*	8.23.2021
RP1	2021.A.23	August 5th, 2021	Can Indigo use "SME Ranges" (which are approved by agronomists as a means to help validate the data inputted by the Field Managers) to support Field Managers that have not accommodated the process outlined in Section 6.1 due to lack of evidence?	n/a	Yes. The Reserve will allow this as it is viewed as a reconstruction of the process outlined in Section 6.1, and is therefore acceptable.	SO: These ranges will be subject to verification, and ideally will be presented to Reserve staff at some point, potentially requiring Reserve approval. We can probably forgo Reserve approval of such ranges during first RP.	*Approved*	8.23.2021
RP1	2021.A.24	August 5th, 2021	Is it possible for us to consider time-stamped data entry into our software as "evidence" under Section 6.1 of the SEP?	n/a	Yes. The Reserve will allow this, especially considering the use of SME Ranges will reduce the risk of direct data entry.	SO: I think this type of evidence may be particularly useful only for a subset of parameters, ie those which have a temporal component, and likely less useful for parameters which have a more material quantitive impact on emission reductions, such as fertilizer usage. Hopefully Indigo will provide the verifier and Reserve with data QA/QC methodology which will outline methodology used, including use of ranges and time/date stampted photos as evidence.	*Approved*	8.23.2021
RP1	2021.A.25	August 5th, 2021	Can a field end its crediting period (because the farmer drops out) and then re-enter its crediting period later if a new tenant/owner decides to rejoin the carbon program? This assumes that, in the interim, the project developer has been monitoring and reporting for reversals.	n/a	Yes. The Reserve will allow any tenat (original or new) to rejoin the program assuming that the crediting period of that field has not past 30 years, and that ongoing monitoring and reporting as been conducted for the "silent" period.		*Approved*	8.23.2021
RP1	2021.A.26	August 5th, 2021	Is it acceptable for the modeling of SOC to end prior to the end of the reporting period? Our team is constrained since DayCent-CR is currently engineered to produce monthly outputs, and it is likely that cultivation cycles will end mid-month.. Since we only collect management data from farmers through the end of the cultivation cycle, we will not have management data to feed the model to keep running it to the end of the month which contains the end of the reporting period.	n/a	Yes. The Reserve will allow this.	SO: Note the intent here is to use data spanning through until mid October, to then extrapolate through until the end of the given RP (November sometime). It is anticipated that this approval would only be needed for the first RP, as Soil Metrics is currently working on a version update to account for this issue.	*Approved*	8.23.2021

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RP1	2021.A.27	August 5th, 2021	When accounting for avoidable reversals in the instance where a field exits a project, can project developers have the option of either: 1. Subtracting the reversal from the net issuance at the next verification; or, 2. Keeping the reversal accounting completely separate, surrendering a commensurate quantity of CRTs to the Reserve, and not deducting this amount from the next issuance.	n/a	Yes. Ths Reserve will approve this as long as the total sequestered carbon remains positive.	SO: Note the protocol does still stipulate a requirement to use SEP CRTs to meet reversals and only use other CRTs where SEP CRTs fall short of reversal requirements.	*Approved*	8.23.2021
RP1	2021.A.28	August 5th, 2021	"Previously CAR mentioned that their approval would be contingent on Brian M.'s approval. As Indigo has now received approval from Brian M., we are requesting approval from CAR for the proposal desecribed below. We have developed an approach for how Indigo will validate organic amendment applications, and are looking to seek approval for the attached proposal. More information is below. The SEP v1.0 and the accompanying modeling guidance document require that a biogeochemical model be validated for each combination of Practice Category (PC) and Crop Functional Group (CFG) occurring in the project. This requirement is based on the assumption that each combination of PC and CFG has unique biogeochemical effects on soil emissions. For the case of the Organic Amendment PC, large carbon inputs to the soil dominate the effects of soil carbon accrual, and as we explain below, outweigh the differential effects between CFGs. A holistic validation of the Organic Amendment PC should instead focus on evaluating model performance and uncertainty across a range of climates, soil types, and fertilization regimes for representative cropping systems, as done in the literature. "	Proposal for validating organic amendment applications	The Reserve gives tacit approval until Brian M. is able to complete a review and provide formal approval to Indigo and CAR.		*Approved*	8.23.2021
RP1	2021.A.29	August 5th, 2021	How are baselines reassessed at the point of crediting period renewal? Assuming the SEP looks the same in 2028 as it does now (obviously not likely), will the approach be to simply see if the current baseline still passes through the additionality screens? So the only thing that would change is if common practice threshold now catches one of those practices, they'd go into the baseline? Example: field adopts cover crops and no-till in the first crediting period, then at renewal no-till is now identified as common practice, the field remains eligible but no-till is now a baseline management practice and credits are only generated on continued cover cropping? Or do they have to adopt new practices and the first crediting period managment becomes the new "historical baseline period?"	n/a	No. Your baseline is your baseline for 30 years (if you are able to achieve the full crediting period with both renewals) and at each renewal, each field has to pass 'eligibility'. Therefore, if the field was originally eligible under one practice change that was updated to become a common practice before the time of the field's crediting period renewal, than that field will now be ineligible as it would not pass the PST. The only situation where the field would be eligible under the PST is if there was stacking on that field.	thinking, and discussions I've had with other Reserve staff. This is also not inconsistent with the guidance in Section 5.1, which makes it clear baseline modeling needs to continue uninterupted for up to 30 years. The guidance in Sections 3.4.1.3 and 3.4.1.4 is probably more instructive here, and does reference historal data from prior to start date. I think this articulates a pretty clear intent to not update baselines at the end of each CP. I would suggest this is sufficient to demonstrate intent enshrined in the SEP. I would further suggest that should Reserve thinking change, it would be reasonable to expect a full version protocol update would be needed to make any such changes explicit within the abovereferenced sections of the protocol.	*Approved*	8.23.2021
RP1	2021.A.30	August 5th, 2021	Can you please review the questions below which outlines the logic our team is using to evaluate field start dates? Note our team has submitted an attachment to visually represent this logic using diagrams with explicit references to the SEP. The logic includes: 1) Can we add a field later so long as the field start date is after the project start date? For example, fields with crops or in regions where we can't currently model them? Can they receive credits for past vintages, or only for vintages which have not yet been verified? 2) How can we deal with overlapping reporting periods? If the project start date is harvest 2018 and a practice change occured in 2019, they would ideally be part of the 2021 vintage. If we don't collect data their in time and have to push them to the 2022 vintage, would we be eligible to generate credits for the 2021 and 2022 years for those fields in 2022? 3) When we add a field later, with a field start date prior to the end of the overall project's previous reporting period, will we violate the requirement that verification reports be submitted within 12 months of the end of the reporting period? Or can the initial reporting period at the field level be greater than 12 months.	Lookbacks and creditable periods	1) Yes, as long as the field meets the first 24-month submittal deadline. 2) Yes, as long as the field meets the first 24-month submittal deadline. Since the project will have field-level Reporting Periods, it is possible to generate credits in the 2022 vintage for fields during a time period that covered by the project-level Reporting Period in the 2021 vintage. As long as the field-level Reporting Period does not overlap, then the respective fields should be eligible for credit generation in 2022. 3) No, you don't violate that requirement because you can report up to 3 cultivation cycles in a field's initial verification. Another way of saying it is: if a field is unable to get into the project verification process by the Reporting Deadline for its initial Reporting Period, but the overall Project does undergo verification, the field may be included in the subsequent verification cycle, which would thus cover 3 cultivation cycles for that field.	SO: We will need some pretty detailed project / field tracking, and we should also discuss making such detail public, as this type of functionality could raise concerns in marketplace re ability to track and avoid double issuance. I had discussed this extensively internally to the Reserve, and I think I can approve this. However, now we are exploring updates to the protocol, where I will look to enshrine this guidance in updates, and it's different Reserve staff engaged in such decision-making at this point, so it's not 100% clear we'll still have consensus to enshrine this in protocol updates. We need to update Section 7.2 to allow for initial RP for each field to be 24 months, in addition to current allowance for initial project RP to be up to 24 months. We should also update Section 7.3 to allow for verification cycle for each field to be up to 5 cultivation cycles, but in no instance should any verification span more than 5 cultivation cycles. I'd like this to include ability for new fields to immediately defer verifiction up to 5 reporting periods, however I do think	*Approved*	8.23.2021

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RP1	2021.A.31	August 5th, 2021	public. Would CAR allow only the main text of the Validation Report to be public, and allow all appendices and supporting data to be protected IP, only made available to CAR and project verifiers as described in the IP Framework proposal document. This is because work on components such as validation datasets involved significant time and effort on our part and that of our modeling partners, and would greatly benefit competitors. The main text of the validation report presents the scientific methods and the domain of the validated model at the level of CFGs/PCs. It also makes clear that the detailed datasets and appendices can be made available for research purposes, if academic entities want to reach out to Indigo to make an arrangement as part of our scientific collaborations.	Final Indigo Validation Report IP Framework Proposal	CAR is not requried to give formal guidance on this, but the document submitted by Indigo looks acceptable and can be used for this reporting period.		*Approved*	8.23.2021
RP1	2021.A.32	August 5th, 2021	Our team is requesting CAR to allow for an interpretation of the Section 6.1 data hierarchy described in attached figure 'Section 6.1 Modified Data Hierarchy.pdf'. As a part of this interpretation, we are requesting CAR allow the inclusion of a new form of Level 2 gap-filling for the purposes of filling missing attributes, called 'gap-filling with data extrapolation'. Gap-filling with data extrapolation may only occur if a field meets PST without this form gap-filling, and the process will follow logic of Level 1c to extrapolate qualifying data for both qualitative and quantitative attributes that are missing. See attached figure for details.	Section 6.1 Modified Data Hierarchy	This is approved by CAR and expected to be integrated into the SEP with collaboration from Indigo at a later date.	SO: The Reserve approves the use of this methodology whereby data extrapolation will be acceptable. The Reserve will seek further information from Indigo including further detailed description of the methodology, critically also further description of the safeguards employed with respect to extrapolation, some process for validating/verifying logic/code used in software to automate implementation, some form of analysis of the impacts on emission reductions resulting from implementation of the methodology, and likely some summary of sources of inputs and results etc. The Reserve will then approve use thereof before Aster is then also asked to consider whether the given approach is applied reasonably.	*Approved*	8.23.2021
RP1	2021.A.33	August 5th, 2021	Indigo requests permission to use a revision to SEP Appendix D that has recieved several rounds of feedback from CAR and other entities, that addresses a gap in the use of Monte Carlo methods for uncertainty. The methods in this revised Appendix D were also written in v4.4 of Addressing Missing Data in row 5, which underwent external review. Please see the attached documents for more detail.	Appendix D revision v4, Explanation of the proposed Appendix D Monte Carlo revision; final memo missingness guidance JAK	This has been approved by CAR after reviewing these documents in detail with external parties, and receiving clarifying questions from Indigo.		*Approved*	8.23.2021
RP1	2021.A.34	August 5th, 2021	Indigo requests permission to list newly enrolled fields in an alternative format (such as in a digital database, as mentioned in Section 2.2.3.1 of the SEP v1.0).		This is approved by CAR with the expectation that all required information to enroll fields through the Project Submittal form and/or Field Enrollment & Transfer form will be included in Indigo's "alternative" format.	SO: Very sensible, however we should briefly discuss making such information public.	*Approved*	8.23.2021
RP1	2021.A.35	August 10th, 2021	Indigo requests permission to use proposed requirements in the "Proposal for Cross-Validation Methods for Model Calibration and Validation", which addresses a gap in the current Model Requirements document describing Bayesian-based methods for model calibration and validation, setting requirements for their use and reporting in a Validation Report, and clarifying reporting of model prediction error for use in an SEP project.	Proposal for Cross Validation Methods for Model Calibration and Validation	The Reserve gives tacit approval until Brian M. is able to complete a review and provide formal approval to Indigo and CAR in Annex B of his review of the Validation Report	SO: Yes, the Reserve gives tacit approval for this approach, noting that Indigo will be running this proposal through an independent third-party expert review, as part of the further independent validation report expert review bring conducted by Brian/Viresco.	*Approved*	8.23.2021
RP1	2021.A.36	August 23rd, 2021	Indigo requests permission to include fields in their project which have start dates earlier than Sep 30th 2018, but that fall within cultivation season which does not end prior to Sep 30th 2018.		The Reserve approves this request and an update to the protocol will enshrine such guidance. Any cultivation cycle with a start date that begins in 2018 and does not end prior to September 30th 2018, is eligible.		*Approved*	8.23.2021
RP1	2021.A.36	August 24th,	Section 2.2.2 of the SEP states that the project area shall not contain any histosols", "If the project area includes land classified as highly erodible land (HEL), that land must meet federal Highly Erodible Land Conservation provisions to be eligible under this protocol" and that "If the project area includes land classified as wetlands,that land must meet federal Wetlands Conservation provisions to be eligible under this protocol". In practice, Indigo is looking to translate these requirements into logic and determine a threshold that would flag each scenario as problematic. Is it acceptable to use a threshold of 50 acres or 33% of the field area (whichever is smaller) to accomodate each requirement mentioned above?		Yes. After thorough conversations with Indigo (of April and May of 2021), CAR feels this is reasonable and Indigo is approved to move forward with this logic.		*Approved*	8.26.2021
RP1	2021.A.37	August 24th,	Does Indigo have approval for the county-level common practice assessment submitted on 10/22/2020?	Indigo county additionality proposal (Jan2021)	Yes. The proposal subumitted requesting the use of the PST option in Section 3.4.1.2.(2)(1) for Demonstrating new tillage practices are still rotated with conventional tillage was approved on 4/30/2021.		*Approved*	8.26.2021

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RP2	2022.A.7	July 7th, 2022	Can you please confirm that the language in the SEP in Section 5.4.3 Carbon Dioxide Emissions below should be: Where projects can show that the total CO2 emissions reductions from fossil fuels are de minimis (i.e., the absolute value of emission reductions from fossil fuels is less than 5% of total emission reductions), the project developer may propose an alternative estimation approach. The verifier shall confirm that such an approach is reasonable and conservative.		Yes, CAR agrees with the proposed updates to Section 5.4.3 of the SEP.			*Nov 9th, 2022*
RP2	2022.A.6	July 7th, 2022	Indigo's alternative estimation approach for determining de minimis is to compare the *absolute value* of total fossil fuel emissions reductions between the baseline and project scenario to the total emissions reductions in the project. Do you agree with this alternative estimation approach?	Fossil fuel clarifications and supporting information.pdf	Yes, we agree with the proposed alternative estimation approach.			*Nov 9th, 2022*
RP2	2022.A.29	Nov 3rd, 2022	Can you please confirm that the PIA is not expected to be executed before the verification report is submitted?		VVB can submit the verification report for review without the PIA having been signed, that is standard practice for all other land use project types. Once we review the report, a verification observation will be for VVB to edit the report and confirm review of the signed PIA. If the PIA is not ready by the time you have submitted the first iteration of the verification report, CAR will advise the VVB on next steps. In general, it is acceptable to leave only the PIA observation open, as that is common for all our land-based project types.	*Approved*	*Nov 3rd, 2022*
RP2	2022.A.22	Jun 27th, 2022	Submission of Indigo's Second Model Validation report.	CAR1459_model_val_DayCentCR_1.0.2.pdf	An approval email was submitted to Indigo on October 26, 2022 for Indigo's Second Model Validation Report.		*Approved*	*Oct 26th, 2022*
RP2	2022.A.20	Mar 11th, 2022	How should project developers deal with adding fields in the second reporting period that will change the project start date? For example, say a field enters the project during the second reporting period and has a field start date that is before the project start date (that was set in the first reporting period). How would a project developer deal with that?		CAR will allow the project start date to change if new fields enter the project that have a field start date earlier than the pre-existing project start date.		*Approved*	*Oct 20th, 2022*
RP2	2022.A.14	April 29th, 2022	Previously, Indigo received approval to consider time-stamped data entries as evidence for our SEP project (as found in 2021.A.24 of the Indigo US1 Project_CAR Requests_2021_10.05 approved guidance). Indigo is now following up on what we consider to be an acceptable threshold to allow time-stamped data entries as evidence and have concluded that 15 days would be an appropriate threshold. This precedent has already been set by the FSA which generally requires the reporting of spring crop data and prevent plant or of a crop disaster to be reported within 15 days. We believe this strikes a reasonable balance between being practical for farmers and controlling the risk of data entry error. Do you agree with the proposal above?		Yes, CAR agrees with the proposed threshold.		*Approved*	*Sept 8th, 2022*
RP2	2022.A.11	June 24th, 2022	Can you confirm the reporting needs described below are correct? That the project developer only has to submit an updated Field Enrollment and Transfer form for fields entering pre-existing Projects. (Per Section 2.2.3.1 Entering an Aggregated Project) The project developer has to submit a project map (in KML format for each field and an overall project map) and an updated Field Enrollment and Transfer form for each reporting period (i.e., before entering verification for that reporting period(s))? (per Section 7.1 Project Documentation)		The understanding is correct.		*Approved*	*Sept 8th, 2022*
RP2	2022.A.10	June 24th, 2022	Continuing on from the request above regarding the Field Enrollment and Transfer Form, Indigo is seeking clarification on how the project developer should populate Crop, Project Practices, and Last Date of Harvest. We would like to suggest that these columns be removed from the Field Enrollment and Transfer Form, as they are going to change every year. If these columns are required by the registry, then we would suggest that the project developer can either: 1. Use only the information gathered in the initial reporting period, or 2. Update the information for every reporting period. Therefore, the Crop, Project Practices, and Last Date of Harvest will be updated (if applicable) every time is submitted to CAR.		CAR agrees that data columns need not be updated after the first reporting period, and therefore Option 1 is approved.		*Approved*	*Sept 8th, 2022*

Cycle	Unique ID	Submission	Question / Clarification	Supporting Documentation	CAR Response	CAR Notes	CAR Approval	Approval Date (MM.DD.YYYY)
RP2	2022.A.9	June 24th, 2022	Previously, Indigo received approval to list newly enrolled fields in an "alternative format" (as found in 2021.A.24 of the Indigo US1 Project_CAR Requests_2021_10.05 approved guidance). CAR's response was that "all required information to enroll fields through the Project Submittal Form and/or Field Enrollment and Transfer Form are included in Indigo's "alternative format". " but there was never any indication of what fields were required. Can you please clarify this? If there are required fields that were not populated on previous submissions, will those previous submissions still be valid? For reference, the information included on the Field Enrollment and Transfer form are: Field ID Field Start Date Field Size (acres) Crop State County Project Practices Last Date of Harvest		At the point of the initial verification submission, all columns should be populated to reflect the first reporting period data. However, before that point, the project developer should populate the form to the best of their ability and at a minimum, provide data for Field ID, Field Start Date (which can be estimated), State and County.		*Approved*	*Sept 8th, 2022*
RP2	2022.A.1	January 21st,	The SEP on page 27 requires SOC remeasurement at least every 5 years. The SEP is designed for projects to take a sample-based approach, whereby not every field is sampled. However, rigorous sample design requires that every field must have the *opportunity* to be sampled, meaning it is included in the process of randomization. Thus, in the frame of context of the requirement for resampling every 5 years, the logical conclusion is that what is actually required is that a field have the *opportunity* to be sampled at least every 5 years by being included in a randomization.		to the project as a whole, rather, it can be applied at a field/strata/cohort level. (Can you please clarify what a cohort is within a stratum?) You do need to have the whole project trued up every five years. This means that every cohort/field/strata will have their own timelines. This is linked to the importance of having a robust stratification design to understand how individual sample points and cohorts relate to changes in stratum assignments over time. For example, if a field is part of Cohort A and plots on it were assigned to Stratum X, and if Cohort A is sampled in year 3 but the field undergoes some change that leads it to being reassigned to Stratum Y, those plots not only would be associated with that new stratum but would have to maintain their Cohort A sampling schedule or perhaps be resampled sooner under a new cohort if you're trying to align sampling cohorts and strata. It would be best if you begin randomization and remeasurement a year earlier to make sure that all fields are resampled within the five year mark. It's better to have some fields sampled from 4 to 5 years than 5 to 6 years.	Verbally confirmed with Kristen G.	*Approved*	Feb 1st, 2022
RP2	2022.A.2	March 14th,	Can you confirm if the first vintage year of a field counts as "year 1" of their permanence commitment, and thus each field will have 99 years remaining under their permanence obligations?	RE_ Permanence of the first vintage of a project.eml	I said I would be following up with you regarding the permanence period left for the first vintage of credits in a project. We want to confirm that a project using TYA should consider the first vintage of their project as permanence accrued. In other words, under your project with a 30-year permanence commitment, you would have 29 years left of permanence to accrue for your first vintage of credits. update: Having a 30 year PIA does not change our guidance.		*Approved*	Mar 23rd, 202
RP2	2022.A.3	April 1st, 202	Mike Dietze will be the external reviewer for Indigo's second Model Validation Report (that will be used in Indigo's second reporting period). As you are well aware, Mike Deets was the external reviewer for Indigo's first Model Validation Report and has already signed the COI. Is it correct to assume that Mike will not have to sign the COI again?		You do not need to submit a second COI if the content of the first COI is still correct.	Verbally confirmed with Kristen G.	*Approved*	4.22.22
RP3	2023.A.1	March 29th, 2022	Can Indigo defer verification at the field level? (*Note: this clarification has been submitted to CAR as a SEP update.)	field_deferrals_proposal.pdf	Yes, fields may defer verification, so long as cultivation cycles are tracked correctly. This update will be considered in the upcoming SEP update.		*See field_deferrals_approval_7-11-23.pdf*	*7/11/2023*
RP3	2023.A.2	April 20th, 2023	The current quantification approach in the SEP shows the decision point of process-based models vs empirical models (i.e., default equations) occurring at a level that doesn't necessarily match the outputs from process-based models. For example, the SEP shows that all N2O emissions reductions must go through the same approach. The SEP was originally intended to allow for this "hybrid quantification approach" - allowing for both process-based and empirical modeling to be used for emissions estimation. Can Indigo use a process-based model for direct N2O emissions and use of the empirical approach (default equations) for indirect N2O emissions?		Yes, quantification may be broken down by direct / indirect emissions in this way.			*4/24/2023*

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RP3	2023.A.3	April 20th, 2023	Can Indigo model N2O at every datapoint where the model is valid (with validity determined by the domain declared in that model's Model Validation Report), and calculate N2O from default equations at any datapoints where the model is not valid? (*Note: this clarification has been submitted to CAR as a SEP update.)		Yes, as long as there is a note that if N2O can be modelled, it is, and direct equations are only used where modelling isn't available.		See N2O_approval_5-8-23.pdf.	*5/8/2023*
RP3	2022.A.4	July 18th, 2022	Projects may not include areas which have been cleared of native ecosystems, including established and restored grasslands, within the 10 years prior to the project start date. The prohibition on clearing native ecosystems does not include the removal of a small numbers of trees, such as the removal of trees We previously had our check set to check for land conversion on a field looking back 10 years from the project start date . However, we changed the code recently to look at 10-yr conversions based on field start date. Can you clarify what the land conversion check should actually be based on? It seems like field start date would make more sense if the intention is to make sure land has been under cultivation for a continuous period, but the SEP language explicitly states project start date.		This makes sense on the field level.			*27-Jan-23*
RP3	2022.A.12	May 25th, 2022	[redacted] allocation approach (as described on page 33 of the SEP) between reporting periods? Page 33: For project designs where some or all of the quantification occurs at the point, stratum, or project level (without first occurring at the field level), it is necessary to allocate reversible and non-reversible emission reductions back to the field level for purposes of quantifying reversals and assigning vintages. Such allocation may use stratum averages or approaches that are more locally accurate, such as verified model runs on similar fields. Verifiers shall confirm that field-level results sum correctly to the project level, and that the allocation approach results in reasonable estimates at the field level.		Yes the project developer is allowed to change their allocation approach over time, subject to verifier review. Any risk related to this change is taken on by the project developer.			*27-Jan-23*
RP3	2022.A.13	April 29th, 2022	Proposal for Handling Permanence in CAR1459 RP2	permanence_proposal_clarification.pdf; see sources in the folder "permanence proposal sources".	The permanence proposal has been approved.		See permanence_approval_3-9-23.pdf.	*3/9/2023*
RP3	2022.A.26	Sep 27th, 2022	Does CAR require field IDs not to change over time after being officially submitted on the field submittal list?		No, CAR does not have a preference on this as long as the project developer can easily track how the field ID changed over time.			*21-Nov-23*
RP3	2022.A.27	Sep 27th, 2022	When will CAR require AR6 to be used in project quantifications?		CAR does not have a plan to require AR6 yet. Based on the memo from July 13, 2022, AR4 should be used for years before 2021 and AR5 should be used for following years.			*teams message: 4/24/23*
RP3	2022.A.29	Oct 7th, 2022	Currently, Equation 5.29 requires that fuel consumption data be collected based on vehicle or equipment type. We would like to propose that instead, consumption could be determined based on public data for fuel consumption rates by event type. Does this seem reasonable?	CAR_propoosal_ff_use_estimation_04192023_revised.docx	The FF proposal has been approved.		See FF_approval_4-26-23.pdf.	*4/26/2023*
RP3	2022.A.30	Aug 26th, 2022	As described on Page 7 of the Verification Program Manual, the project developer shall determine the materiality threshold using the number of CRTs that are being registered for that project within that verification period. Therefore, CRTs that were previously issued for a project are not included in the determination of the materiality threshold for future verification periods. Can you please confirm this?		Yes, this understanding is correct.			*21-Nov-23*
RP3	2022.A.31	February 9th, 2023	Are virtual site visits acceptable for verification?	21047.02 CAR1459 Indigo RP3 Virtual Site Visit Expectations.pdf	Yes, virtual site visits are an acceptable alternative to in-person site visits based on the proposal submitted by Aster Global. As per the protocol, CAR will need to see the selected fields before final approval.			*6/2/2023*
RP3	2022.A.34	Aug 5th, 2022	For cases of gap-filling historical management data for growers who are missing historical values because they didn't farm the land before a certain point in time – Can we extrapolate a grower's own data or with regional norms (second option has potential to eliminate additionality)?		Yes, a grower's own data can be extrapolated to gapfill data before the land was managed. The grower must demonstrate that something has happened in the past, which can then be supported with regional data. Confirm the approach is acceptable for gap filling missing data in the baseline.		data_extrapolation_for_baseline_period_approval_11-22-23	22-Nov-23
RP3	2022.A.35	July 5th, 2023	Can we compensate for erroneous credits using the method described? See attached.	error_compensation_removal_7-7-23.pdf	Yes.		error_compensation_removal_7-7-23.pdf	7-Jul-23
RP3	2023.A.36	Oct 12th, 2023	If using IPCC data, it should be the latest 2019 source, and that given the option between applying those data now, vs. re-quantifying RP3 data with newer MET data later, we chose to make the fix now, and resubmit the data package for RP3 with the 2019 revision data to the verifier as soon as possible. Can you please confirm this guidance is still applicable?		Use of the 2019 IPCC data to determine the ratio is acceptable and an approved approach for verification.		wet_and_dry_field_classification_data_approval_10-13-23	12-Oct-23

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RP3	2023.A.37	Oct 12th, 202	CAR and Indigo arrived at the conclusion that the weighted average approach was sufficiently robust to fix the problem of the differential cultivation cycles. The result of this decision is that the second fix will be treated as a future process improvement and will not be required to be applied to the baseline scenario in order for this quantification verification to continue. Can you please confirm this guidance is still applicable?		This is acceptable and an appoved approach for verification.		normalizing_cultivation_cycle_time_periods_approval_10-13-23	12-Oct-23
RP4	2023.A.1	12-Apr-24	Are CAR/SEP projects compatible with Farmers for Soil Health Climate Smart Commodity Grant?	Farmers for S	Just wanted to follow up on this to let you know we did discuss this program further internally and agree that this enhancement payment would be eligible for stacking with SEP fields. Provided the stipulations you mentioned - namely timing of enrollment coming around the same time and confirming fields do not enter both the marketplace program and carbon program - are followed we don't see any issue with this. As always, still disclose these payments to the verifier and the verifier should also be verifying these stipulations.		*Yes*	*9/26/2024*
RP4	2023.A.3	22-Jul-24	Can a field change its ID number listed on the RFL? The need originated from having two IDs assocaited with the same polygon, one being used by source, one being used by carbon. The ID for the Carbon field had no data associated with it, so the easiest move would be to crosswalk the ids on a file on the registry portal and delete the id with no associated data.		I don't see any issues with a change in field ID after submittal as long as it is clearly documented that the previous field ID was replaced, the same field specifics are maintained, and that previous or new ID is not found in any other program.		*Yes*	*9/4/2024*
RP4	2023.A.4	18-Jul-24	Should we treat any field no longer participating in the project as genereating a net-negative on the active verification, or can we hold them separate and return CRTs to the reserve following issuance, allowing us to pay growers on the full issuance, rather than having active growers subsidize inactive growers, Indigo takes on that burden. We will report the inactive fields as a seperate line item on the Verification report.		We did discuss further internally and do not have any concerns with you showing the credits for active fields separately from fields in their permanence period assuming the net credits will be stated in the report and would be accounted for in that current reporting period.		*Yes*	*7/29/2024*
RP4	2023.A.5	30-Apr-24	Status of erroneous credited fields. Confirm that there should be no language saying that fields erroneously credited because of a deep till to no-till logic violation should be removed from the project. They should only be ineligible for that RP but can be eligible in the future.		Correct, language incorporated.		*Yes*	*5/1/2024*